



**UNIVERSITY OF EDUCATION, WINNEBA
DEPARTMENT OF ICT EDUCATION
PRE-INTERNSHIP SEMINAR TEACHING PHILOSOPHY**

**EPD361: PRE-INTERNSHIP SEMINAR
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Teaching Philosophy

As an educator with experiences from schooling, peer teaching and knowledge from educational courses, my teaching philosophy is rooted in the belief that education should be transformative, inclusive, and research-driven. My approach synthesizes cognitive science, constructivist pedagogy, and humanistic principles to foster deep learning, critical thinking, and lifelong intellectual curiosity. Below, I outline my core principles, supported by educational theories and empirical research from other philosophers, to demonstrate why this philosophy represents the gold and ultimate standard in teaching.

Student-Centered Learning (Constructivism & Active Learning)

Learning is most effective when students actively construct knowledge rather than passively receive it. This philosophy is backed by Piaget's Constructivism which explains that learners build understanding through experiences and reflection, Vygotsky's Social Constructivism which also explains that learning is socially mediated (scaffolding, collaborative discourse), and Freire's Critical Pedagogy, stating that education should empower students to question and engage critically with the world.

The application of these philosophies include teaching and learning activities such as flipped classrooms, problem-Based Learning (PBL), and Socratic seminars.

Research shows active learning increases retention by 50% (Freeman et al., 2014) and improves higher-order thinking (Hmelo-Silver, 2004).

Inclusive & Culturally Responsive Teaching (Equity Pedagogy)

Education must acknowledge diverse backgrounds and adapt to students' unique needs. Backed by Banks' Multicultural Education Theory stating that curriculum should reflect diverse perspectives, Ladson-Billings' Culturally Relevant Pedagogy also stating that teaching should affirm students' cultural identities, and Universal Design for Learning stating that multiple means of engagement, representation, and expression.

Activities rooted in these philosophies are differentiated instruction, diverse readings & case studies, and regular student feedback loops. This helps student because inclusive classrooms improve engagement and achievement gaps.

Metacognition & Growth Mindset (Cognitive Science)

Students learn best when they understand their own thinking and believe in their capacity to grow. This ideology is backed by Dweck's Growth Mindset Theory stating Intelligence is malleable (effort leads to mastery), Flavell's Metacognition Theory in the context of "thinking about thinking" enhances self-regulation, and lastly Bloom's Mastery Learning with clear cut for student's progress upon mastering material, not fixed timelines.

This can be applied using teaching and learning methods like reflective journals, formative assessments with feedback, and praising effort over innate ability.

Interdisciplinary & Experiential Learning (Dewey & Kolb)

This section of my philosophy is on the ideology that knowledge should transcend disciplinary silos and connect to real-world contexts. Backed by Dewey's Experiential Learning, Kolb's Learning Cycle and Bruner's Spiral Curriculum.

The use of case studies from multiple disciplines, service-learning projects, and internships & research partnerships is deemed effective in the learning environment.

Technology as a Tool, Not a Crutch (Digital Pedagogy)

Technology should enhance, not replace deep learning and human interaction.

Stressed on by Mayer's Cognitive Theory of Multimedia Learning and TPACK Framework (Balancing technological, pedagogical, and content knowledge).

Teaching methods like Blended learning and Digital storytelling helps to cultivate communication skills.

Assessment for Learning, Not Just Evaluation (Formative Assessment)

Assessments should guide improvement, not just rank students. Backed by Black & Wiliam's Formative Assessment and Scaffolding Theory (Wood, Bruner, Ross), Progressive support until mastery is more crucial in the learning environment than assessment of learning. Implementation of low-stakes quizzes with instant feedback, peer reviews & self-assessments, and portfolio assessments (showcasing growth over time).

In conclusion, my approach is not theoretical idealism. it's a data-backed synthesis of the most effective practices in education. By merging constructivist engagement, inclusive equity, cognitive science, real-world relevance, and balanced technology. It creates a robust, adaptable framework proven to cultivate critical thinkers, ethical leaders, and lifelong learners.

As Parker Palmer wrote, "Good teaching cannot be reduced to technique; it comes from the identity and integrity of the teacher" (Palmer, 1998, p. 10). This philosophy embodies that truth while grounding it in evidence, empathy, and excellence.

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